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comment `\selectfont` to see the difference:

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Etiam lobortis facilisis sem. Nullam nec mi et neque pharetra sollicitudin. Praesent imperdiet mi nec ante. Donec ullamcorper, felis non sodales commodo, lectus velit ultrices augue, a dignissim nibh lectus placerat pede. Vivamus nunc nunc, molestie ut, ultricies vel, semper in, velit. Ut porttitor. Praesent in sapien. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Duis fringilla tristique neque. Sed interdum libero ut metus. Pellentesque placerat. Nam rutrum augue a leo. Morbi sed elit sit amet ante lobortis sollicitudin. Praesent blandit blandit mauris. Praesent lectus tellus, aliquet aliquam, luctus a, egestas a, turpis. Mauris lacinia lorem sit amet ipsum. Nunc quis urna dictum turpis accumsan semper. The default value of `\baselineskip=30.0pt`. Now update

`\baselinestretch`. However, although we have executed

```
\renewcommand\baselinestretch{2.5}
```

it *has not* (yet) had any effect: the new value of `\baselinestretch` is stored, but not actioned. We can issue a `\selectfont` command to make the change take effect; but, for now, the value of `\baselineskip` is still 30.0pt (unchanged).

If we now execute `\selectfont` the change to `\baselinestretch`, setting it to 2.5, will now take effect—even though we are in the middle of a paragraph. Now, the value of `\baselineskip` is 30.0pt ($= 2.5 \times 12 = 30\text{pt}$).

What happens if we change the font size to 14pt and `\baselineskip` to 16pt using the commands `\fontsize{14}{16}\selectfont`?

Now, `\baselineskip` is *not* 16pt but 40.0pt because

the value of `\baselinestretch` (2.5) has been preserved and applied, giving $\text{\baselineskip} = 2.5 \times 16 = 40\text{pt}$.

1 `\linespread`

The `\linespread` command can be used to modify `\baselinestretch` without changing the font size.